

God Sees the Truth but Waits

- Understanding the text

Answer these questions.

a) What bad habits did Aksionov have ~~before~~ before his marriage?

Ans Aksionov had several bad habits before his marriage. He was fond of drinking and spent much of his time in merry making. He often enjoyed parties and ~~he~~ led a careless life. Because of excessive drinking, he sometimes became riotous and lost control over his behavior. His lifestyle was irresponsible and lacked discipline. However, after his marriage, he gave up these habits and became a sober, hardworking, and respectable man.

b) What can be the meaning of his wife's dream?

Ans His wife's dream can be understood as a symbol of warning and fate. The dream, in which Aksionov returns with grey hair, suggests misfortune and suffering in the future. It reflects her inner fear that something bad might happen to her husband during the journey. Symbolically, the dream foreshadows Aksionov's long imprisonment.

and the hardships that turn him old before his time. Thus, the dream hints at the tragic turn his life is about to take.

Q: Why did Aksionov think of killing himself?

Ans: Aksionov ~~thinks~~ thought of killing himself because he had suffered unjust imprisonment for many years and had lost all hope of freedom. He felt that no one believed in his innocence and that justice would never be done. Continuous physical hardship and mental torture made him feel helpless. This extreme despair led him to think that death might be the only escape from his misery.

Q: Why did Makar disclose that he had killed the merchant?

Ans: Makar confessed to killing the merchant because he was deeply affected by Aksionov's forgiveness and kindness. Despite knowing that Makar was the real criminal, Aksionov did not reveal him to the authorities or seek revenge. This unexpected mercy touched Makar's conscience and made him feel guilty. The burden of his sin became unbearable, and he realized he could not hide the truth any longer. Overwhelmed by remorse, he finally admitted to the crime.

e) Why doesn't Aksionov wish to return to his family at the end of the story?

Ans. Aksionov does not want to return to his family because years of suffering in prison have changed him completely. He has grown spiritually detached from worldly desires and no longer cares for comfort, wealth, or family life. His faith and belief in God have become his true solace. He seeks inner peace and spiritual fulfillment rather than worldly happiness, and he feels that returning home would no longer bring him the contentment he has found in faith.

Reference to the Content

a) "Well, old man," repeated the Governor, "tell me the truth: Who has been digging under the wall?"

i) Who is that old man?

Ans. The old man is Aksionov, the honest merchant.

ii) Which truth is the speaker asking about?

Ans. The speaker is asking who really killed the merchant.

iii) Which wall does the speaker mean?

Ans. The wall refers to the prison wall, symbol-

lizing the barrier between Aksionov and justice.

b) Describe Aksionov's character.

Ans: Aksionov is an honest and hardworking merchant who lives a peaceful life with his family. He is cheerful, responsible, and well-respected in his community. He loves his wife and children deeply and enjoys a simple, happy life before tragedy strikes.

His life changes when he is wrongly accused of murder and sent to prison. Despite facing injustice, he remains patient and disciplined. In prison, he faces harsh conditions, loneliness, and suffering. Yet, he adapts to his life behind bars, learns to control his anger, and becomes calm and reflective. He gradually grows spiritually and emotionally, showing remarkable resilience and courage in the face of adversity.

Aksionov also demonstrates great moral courage. When he meets Makar, the real murderer, he forgives him instead of seeking revenge. Through Aksionov's patience, faith and forgiveness, the story shows how suffering can transform a person and lead to wisdom, humility, and inner peace.

c) What is the theme of the story?

Ans The story emphasizes justice, patience, and forgiveness. Aksionov suffers for a crime he did not commit highlighting the human injustice that exists in life.

It also shows the importance of enduring hardship with patience. Years of imprisonment teach Aksionov to control his anger, reflect on life, and understand the value of moral strength. He learns that revenge only brings bitterness, while forgiveness brings peace and spiritual growth. His endurance demonstrates how patience can help a person overcome even the deepest suffering.

Faith in God is another important theme. The story teaches that truth and justice may take time to appear, but they are inevitable. Forgiveness and patience are shown as virtues that bring inner peace and elevate human character.

d) Which symbols are used in the story and what do they indicate?

Ans The prison symbolizes suffering, injustice, and the obstacles between Aksionov and the truth. It represents life's hardships and isolation. The chain symbolizes fate and the li-

imitations on human freedom, showing that destiny cannot easily be avoided.

Makar represents guilt and sin, while his confession symbolizes the triumph of truth.

Aksionov's journey from innocence to spiritual maturity symbolizes growth through suffering. His calmness, patience, and ultimate forgiveness are also symbolic of human strength and moral development, showing that character can be refined even in harsh conditions.

Forgiveness, shown by Aksionov, symbolizes moral strength and humanity. Even the river in the story can symbolize time and patience, flowing until justice prevails. These symbols emphasize the story's themes of justice, patience, moral courage, and forgiveness.

• Reference beyond the text

a) What role does religion play in Aksionov's life? How does he undergo a spiritual transformation in the story?

Ans. Religion plays an important role in Aksionov's life in *Crime and Punishment*. God sees the Truth but waits. Before going to prison, Aksionov lived a happy and careless life. He liked drinking and entertainment and did not think much about God. But after he was falsely accus-

ed and sent to siberia, his life changed completely. He lost his family, freedom, and happiness, and this made him turn toward religion.

During his long years in prison, Aksionov turned deeply towards faith. He began reading the Bible regularly and spent much of his time praying. Religion taught him patience and acceptance, helping him endure injustice without hatred. He stopped blaming fate and instead trusted the God knew the truth, even if humans did not. This belief gave him inner strength and calmness.

Aksionov's spiritual transformation is completed through forgiveness. When he forgives Makar, the real murderer, he frees himself from anger and pain. Religion transforms him into a humble, peaceful and morally strong man, giving him inner freedom before death.

b) What does the story tell us about the existence of unfair system of justice?

Ans: The story God sees the Truth but waits clearly shows that the system of justice can be unfair and unreliable. Aksionov is wrongly accused of murdering a merchant even though he is innocent. The police

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and the court rely only on circumstantial evidence and do not investigate the case properly. Aksionov's words are ignored, and he is sent to prison without strong proof. This shows how easily an innocent person can be punished in an imperfect justice system.

The story also highlights how such injustice can destroy a person's life. Aksionov loses his freedom, his family and his peaceful life because of a false judgment. He spends many years suffering in prison for a crime he did not commit. His case proves that human laws and courts can make serious mistakes.

Through this, the writer suggests that human justice is limited and often unfair, but divine justice is true and patient. God allows injustice for a time, but the truth is eventually revealed.